



YOUTH WORKER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Youth workers support and empower young people—often from disadvantaged or at-risk backgrounds—to improve their personal and social development. They may act as a mentor or counselor, organize activities, or run a drop-in center. Youth workers may specialize in working with young people in a local area or with specific needs, and may be employed by a nonprofit, faith-based group, or government body.



SALARY

Newly qualified youth worker ★★☆☆☆
Youth service manager ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Increasing employment opportunities • Most youth workers employed in the public sector, but jobs also exist in nonprofit and voluntary sectors

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Social work • Sociology • Psychology • Physical Education (PE) • Languages • Team sports • Performing arts • Music



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A good secondary education and a degree or graduate qualification in social work or community services are useful.



LIFESTYLE Working hours vary, with evening and weekend duties often required. Part-time and self-employed work is available.



LOCATION Most of the work is office-based, but many youth workers visit clients in their homes, at school, in the community, or in prison.



THE REALITIES Working with disadvantaged young people requires resilience, and may occasionally involve conflict or threats to personal safety.

CAREER PATHS

Most youth workers are graduates, with many courses including both academic study and practical work to allow students to gain hands-on experience while studying. You can specialize in a number of areas and will be able to apply for more managerial and senior roles after around five years of experience in the job.

ASSISTANT YOUTH WORKER

You can work as an assistant by volunteering for a local authority or nonprofit. You can then study for a degree.



GRADUATE You will need an undergraduate degree in a relevant subject—or a graduate conversion course—and professional accreditation to apply for a job as a youth worker.

